



SUBSTANTIVE CHIT 02 / ONLINE FLAGSHIP SUBMISSION

THE ARSENAL LEDGER

Making stockpile transparency ecologically meaningful without exposing operations

DELEGATION	COMMITTEE	MODERATED-CAUCUS FOCUS
JAPAN	UN GENERAL ASSEMBLY	STOCKPILE DISCLOSURE + ECOLOGICAL ACCOUNTABILITY

Stockpile opacity does not only hide warheads. It hides the scale of fissile-material production, retirement, dismantlement, radioactive waste and long-term remediation. Japan proposes three disciplines: **REPORT**, **PROTECT** and **ACCOUNT**.

12,187	9,745	4,012	>\$500B
ESTIMATED GLOBAL TOTAL INVENTORY	ESTIMATED MILITARY STOCKPILE	ESTIMATED DEPLOYED	REMAINING US DOE CLEANUP ESTIMATE

I | THE RECORD IS INCOMPLETE AND INCOMPARABLE

SIPRI estimates that nine nuclear-armed States possessed approximately 12,187 nuclear weapons in January 2026: 9,745 in military stockpiles and approximately 4,012 deployed with operational forces.^[1] These are estimates—not official national declarations—and SIPRI warns that reduced transparency increasingly obstructs assessment.

The first problem is definitional. A military stockpile includes warheads assigned for possible military use. A total inventory adds retired warheads awaiting dismantlement. A dismantled warhead is no longer a warhead, although its fissile material still requires accounting and disposition.

The United States officially reported 3,748 active and inactive stockpile warheads as of September 2023 and 12,088 dismantlements during fiscal years 1994–2023.^[2] SIPRI’s later total-inventory estimate is larger because it includes another category and date. The figures are not contradictory; they answer different questions.

Disclosure remains uneven. The United Kingdom publishes a ceiling of no more than 260 while withholding operational and deployed categories.^[3] France announced an arsenal increase and ended numerical disclosure on 2 March 2026.^[4] China publishes no-first-use and minimum-deterrence doctrine but no official warhead total.^[5] New START expired on 5 February 2026 without a legally binding successor.^[6]

II | THE ECOLOGICAL LIABILITY BEHIND THE COUNT

Every stockpile implies a material lifecycle: fissile-material production and storage, manufacture, maintenance, transport, retirement, dismantlement, disposition, waste and contaminated facilities. US auditors report that Energy Department sites remain contaminated from decades of weapons production and nuclear-energy research; remaining cleanup was estimated above half a trillion dollars.^[7] A warhead may leave the military stockpile years before its waste leaves the public balance sheet.

III | AUTHORITY AND THE REMAINING GAP

The 2010 NPT Action Plan encouraged a standard reporting form and appropriate intervals.^[8] A 2025 cross-regional statement called for standardized, comparable reports and interactive discussion.^[9] The 2026 NPDI statement called for reports at least twice per Review Cycle.^[10] Yet no universal official register exists. Ordinary IAEA safeguards do not count military warheads, and the General Assembly cannot compel classified disclosure. Japan’s framework respects those limits.



THE PROPOSED FRAMEWORK

IV | REPORT • PROTECT • ACCOUNT

One vocabulary, three security tiers and an environmental balance sheet

01 | REPORT — ONE VOCABULARY + COMPARABLE CATEGORIES

- Total military stockpile or declared ceiling, with date and definition.
- Aggregate deployed strategic and non-strategic categories.
- Reserve or non-deployed warheads; retired warheads awaiting dismantlement.
- Annual dismantlement and fissile material declared excess to military requirements.
- Broad doctrine, risk-reduction and modernization categories.
- Environmental Annex: former production sites, waste, contaminated soil or groundwater, cleanup spending and timelines.
- National data, external estimates and unresolved uncertainty labelled separately.

02 | PROTECT — TRANSPARENCY WITHOUT AN OPERATIONAL BLUEPRINT

- Tier I public aggregates: totals, ceilings, categories, dismantlement and environmental liabilities.
- Tier II protected exchanges: detailed type and notification data through agreed channels.
- Tier III negotiated verification: managed access and information barriers only under mandate and consent.
- Exclude exact locations, movement schedules, command-and-control and precise readiness cycles.
- Exclude weapon designs, proliferation-sensitive isotopic details and exploitable vulnerabilities.

03 | ACCOUNT — INTERACTIVE REVIEW + ENVIRONMENTAL OUTCOMES

- Public UNODA repository with dated versions and category definitions.
- NPT nuclear-weapon States report at least twice per Review Cycle.
- Parallel voluntary track for non-NPT possessors using the same public categories.
- Dedicated interactive sessions for questions, clarification and correction.
- Environmental Annex reviewed beside the force report—from stockpile to waste and remediation.
- Transparency remains a baseline for disarmament, never a substitute for it.

EVIDENCE-TO-ACTION CONTROL LOGIC

FAILURE MODE	WHAT GOES WRONG	JAPAN'S CONTROL
INCOMPATIBLE CATEGORIES	False contradictions and incomparable totals	REPORT: glossary, dates and uncertainty labels
SECURITY OBJECTION	Legitimate secrets used to defend total opacity	PROTECT: public, protected and negotiated tiers
REPORTS WITHOUT REVIEW	Transparency theatre without correction	ACCOUNT: interactive questions + version history
ECOLOGY OMITTED	Warheads counted; waste and cleanup hidden	ENVIRONMENTAL ANNEX: lifecycle balance sheet

A NUMBER WITHOUT A DEFINITION IS NOT TRANSPARENCY.

A report without questions is not accountability; an arsenal ledger without environmental liabilities is incomplete.



FROM FRAMEWORK TO TEXT

V | DRAFT-READY COMMITTEE RECOMMENDATIONS

Three recommendations the General Assembly can adopt without demanding operational secrets

- 1

Requests the Secretary-General, through UNODA and in consultation with interested States, to develop a non-binding Standardized Nuclear Forces and Environmental Accountability Template and public repository;
- 2

Encourages NPT nuclear-weapon States to report at least twice per Review Cycle and invites non-NPT possessors to submit parallel voluntary reports using comparable public categories, followed by dedicated interactive consideration;
- 3

Calls upon participating States to include an Environmental Accountability Annex while protecting locations, movement, command-and-control, readiness, design and proliferation-sensitive information.

VI | IMPLEMENTATION + RESPONSIBILITY MAP

SECRETARY-GENERAL UNODA	/	Consult on definitions; maintain repository and version history; convene interactive review.
NPT STATES	NUCLEAR-WEAPON	Use the common template; report at least twice per cycle; answer technical questions.
NON-NPT POSSESSORS		Use a parallel voluntary route without creating an NPT obligation.
TECHNICAL INSTITUTIONS		Contribute only within mandate; ordinary IAEA safeguards do not become warhead inspections.
COMMUNITIES + EXPERTS		Provide environmental evidence and assess reported cleanup outcomes; supplement, never replace, official data.

COMMON GLOSSARY →	NATIONAL REPORT →	SECURITY REVIEW →	INTERACTIVE QUESTIONS →	CORRECTED REPORT →	ECOLOGY UPDATE
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JAPAN'S ACCOUNTABILITY DECLARATION

44.4 t	Separated civilian plutonium, end-2024 8.6 t in Japan • 35.8 t held abroad • detailed annual reporting since 1994	SAFEGUARDED
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Japan raises its own figure because the principle is universal: disclose the category, define it accurately, submit it to the applicable safeguards system and permit informed scrutiny. This is civilian material—not a warhead stockpile.^[11]

SCOPE + LEGAL SAFEGUARDS

• NO estimates presented as official	• NO exact storage or movements
• NO command-and-control or readiness	• NO design or isotopic disclosure
• NO ordinary IAEA warhead inspections	• NO reporting as a substitute for disarmament

THE WORLD CANNOT REMEDIATE WHAT NUCLEAR POSSESSORS REFUSE TO REPORT.
Disclose the category. Protect the operation. Account for the environmental lifecycle.



EVIDENCE LEDGER / PART I

OFFICIAL RECORDS + NATIONAL DISCLOSURES

Sources 1-6: global estimates, declared counts and current national policies

[1]	SIPRI Yearbook 2026 — World Nuclear Forces 12,187 total inventory; 9,745 military stockpile; approximately 4,012 deployed; transparency warning.	https://www.sipri.org/yearbook/2026/08
[2]	US NNSA — Stockpile Transparency Official 3,748 active/inactive stockpile warheads as of September 2023; 12,088 dismantlements FY1994-2023.	https://www.energy.gov/sites/default/files/2024-08/U.S.%20Nuclear%20Weapons%20Stockpile%20Transparency%207_22_24.pdf
[3]	United Kingdom — 2026 NPT National Report Ceiling no more than 260; operational-stockpile, deployed-warhead and deployed-missile figures withheld.	https://assets.publishing.service.gov.uk/media/69df600a53469bbcdf408e8b/UK-National-Report-11th-Treaty-on-the-Non-Proliferation-of-Nuclear-Weapons-NPT-Review-Conference.pdf
[4]	French Presidency — Île Longue, 2 March 2026 Official announcement of arsenal increase and end to numerical disclosure.	https://www.elysee.fr/en/emmanuel-macron/2026/03/02/visit-to-the-ile-longue-operational-base
[5]	China MOFA — 2025 arms-control white paper No-first-use, self-defence and minimum-deterrence doctrine; no official aggregate warhead count.	https://www.fmprc.gov.cn/mfa_eng/xw/wjbxw/202511/t20251127_11761653.html
[6]	United Nations — New START expiration Secretary-General statement, 5 February 2026: no binding limits on the two largest strategic arsenals; call for successor.	https://media.un.org/unifeed/en/asset/d353/d3532748

CATEGORY DISCIPLINE

MILITARY STOCKPILE	Deployed plus reserve/non-deployed warheads assigned for possible military use.
TOTAL INVENTORY	Military stockpile plus retired warheads awaiting dismantlement.
DISMANTLED	No longer a warhead; fissile material still requires accounting and disposition.
ESTIMATE	External assessment that must never be represented as an official national declaration.

PRECISION RULE:
Date every figure. Define every category. Label every estimate.



EVIDENCE LEDGER / PART II

ACCOUNTABILITY BASIS + JAPAN'S RECORD

Sources 7-11: ecology, reporting commitments and safeguarded civilian material

[7]	US GAO — GAO-26-107820 DOE cleanup sites reflect weapons production and nuclear-energy research; remaining cleanup above half a trillion dollars.	https://www.gao.gov/products/gao-26-107820
[8]	United Nations NPT record — Action 21 Standard reporting form and appropriate intervals, voluntarily and without prejudice to national security.	https://documents.un.org/doc/undoc/gen/n24/140/15/pdf/n2414015.pdf
[9]	Japan MOFA — Cross-regional statement, 9 May 2025 Standardized and comparable national reports plus interactive discussion.	https://www.mofa.go.jp/mofaj/files/100845120.pdf
[10]	NPTDI — 2026 NPT Review Conference statement Nuclear-weapon States report at least twice per Review Cycle; dedicated interactive consideration.	https://estatemements.un.org/estatemements/14.0447/202604281000000/vNCRzyobSXGC/AxTRBODc_nyc_en.pdf
[11]	Japan Atomic Energy Commission — Plutonium 2024 44.4 tonnes separated civilian plutonium; 8.6 domestic, 35.8 abroad; annual reporting and safeguards conclusion.	https://www.aec.go.jp/bunya/04/plutonium/20250805_e.pdf

PRECISION DECLARATIONS

- SIPRI's 12,187 is an estimate, not an official UN or national total.
- The official US 3,748 figure is a September 2023 military-stockpile category—not SIPRI's January 2026 total inventory.
- No unofficial French, Chinese, Russian, Indian, Israeli or DPRK estimate is presented as an official national count.
- Ordinary IAEA safeguards are not assigned a universal warhead-inspection mandate.
- Japan's 44.4 tonnes concern separated civilian plutonium, not nuclear weapons; all material in Japan remains under safeguards.
- Transparency is a basis for accountability and verification, never a substitute for disarmament.

THE STANDARD JAPAN ASKS THE COMMITTEE TO ADOPT:

Report the arsenal. Protect the operation. Account for the cleanup.